

DESIGN SYSTEM SPECIFICATION · V1.0

Build with clarity. Document with intent.

A complete reference for the KV personal brand: color, type, spacing, layout, components, and slide masters — written so every deck, mock, and prototype lands the same way.

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A specification for the KV personal brand — built primarily for executive-ready decks, technical proposals, and analytical communication.

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SECTION 01

A small system, used precisely.

KV is a deliberately narrow visual system. Two type families. Ten colors. One identity color. The rules below are the rules — not suggestions — because consistency is the entire value the system creates.

01

Restrained, not decorative.

No gradients, no decorative SVG, no unnecessary iconography. If something doesn't earn its place on the page, it's removed.

02

Analytical, not promotional.

The system is built for executive review and technical communication, not marketing collateral. Numbers are right-aligned, monospace, and always paired with their comparison.

03

Sentence case, every time.

Titles are sentences. They sound like decisions, not headlines. ALL-CAPS is reserved for short eyebrow trackers and section tags only.

Identity in one paragraph

Cerise Red is the single identity color — section markers, the page accent stripe, key-message bars, the cover background. Deep Teal Blue carries the analytical structure: slide titles, primary chart line, table header rules. Pale Ice Blue is the only soft fill the system allows. Slate replaces plain black on dark surfaces. Soft White, never pure white, is the default canvas. FreeSans Display (bold) sets every headline; FreeSans handles every word that isn't a headline. That is the system.

When the system bends

Cover & section dividers

Allowed to break the type scale (up to 132pt) and use full-bleed Cerise / Slate. They are still subject to every other rule.

Charts & data

The categorical chart palette can use Crimson, Rosewood, Coral, and Sky as additional series colors when more than two categories are present.

SECTION 02

Ten colors. One identity.

The palette is small and load-bearing. Stay inside it. There are no exceptions for "almost" colors.

Reds — primary identity

Cerise Red	Primary identity · markers · accent stripe · key-message bar	#E04556	--kv-cerise
Crimson Red	Strong emphasis · alerts · risk callouts	#D72839	--kv-crimson
Rosewood Red	Secondary accent · contrast blocks · second chart series	#BB3250	--kv-rosewood
Coral Red	Soft emphasis · muted chart series	#E8676A	--kv-coral

Blues — analytical structure

Deep Teal Blue	Slide titles · primary chart line · table header rule	#175676	--kv-deep-teal
Sky Blue	Supporting visuals · secondary chart series	#4BA3C3	--kv-sky
Pale Ice Blue	Soft surface · insight callouts · table emphasis row	#CEE5F3	--kv-pale-ice

Neutrals

Slate	Dark surfaces · cover · primary text · never plain black	#475461	--kv-slate
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SECTION 03

Roles, not just colors.

Tokens are how the palette becomes a system. Use the role, not the hex — that's how decks stay coherent across files and authors.

Surface

	<code>--bg</code>	Default canvas. Used on body, cards, slide background.	<code>#F2F2F2</code>
	<code>--bg-elevated</code>	Elevated surfaces, cards on cards. Pure white only here.	<code>#FFFFFF</code>
	<code>--bg-subtle</code>	Insight callouts, table emphasis row, inline highlights.	<code>#CEE5F3</code>
	<code>--bg-inverse</code>	Dark mode surfaces — cover, closing, dark sections.	<code>#475461</code>
	<code>--bg-accent</code>	Full-bleed accent — section divider, key-message block.	<code>#E04556</code>

Foreground

	<code>--fg-1</code>	Primary text. Body, table cells, default copy.	<code>#475461</code>
	<code>--fg-1-alt</code>	Alternate dark text. Deep Teal when Slate feels too warm — use across a whole surface, not mixed.	<code>#175676</code>
	<code>--fg-2</code>	Secondary heading text. All h1/h2/h3 default to this.	<code>#175676</code>
	<code>--fg-3</code>	Captions, footnotes, source lines, helper text.	<code>#7F77F7</code>
	<code>--fg-on-accent</code>	Text on Cerise / Crimson surfaces.	<code>#FFFFFF</code>

Borders & status

	<code>--border</code>	Hairline 1px between rows, sections, cards.	<code>#D2D2D2</code>
	<code>--border-accent</code>	2–4px Cerise rules, key-message left-borders.	<code>#E04556</code>
	<code>--status-emphasis</code>	High-priority alerts, risk indicators.	<code>#D72839</code>
	<code>--status-info</code>	Informational state, secondary data series.	<code>#4BA3C3</code>

SECTION 04

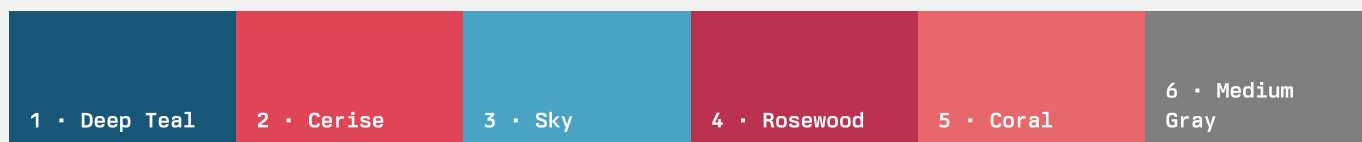
Two-color first. More only when forced.

Most KV charts should use a single Deep Teal series with Cerise reserved for the one number that matters. Add colors only when a chart genuinely has more categories.

Categorical · primary insight pairing



Categorical · full series (in order)



Sequential · teal ramp (low → high)



Sequential · red ramp (low → high)

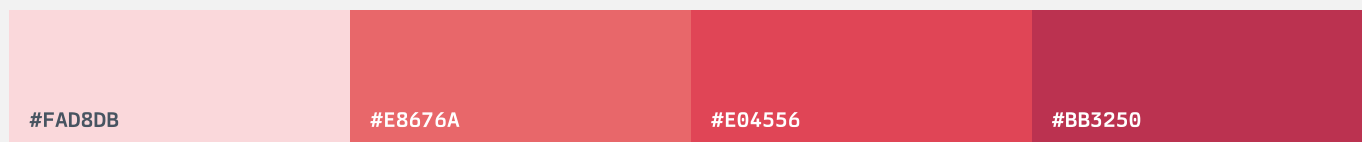


Chart usage rules

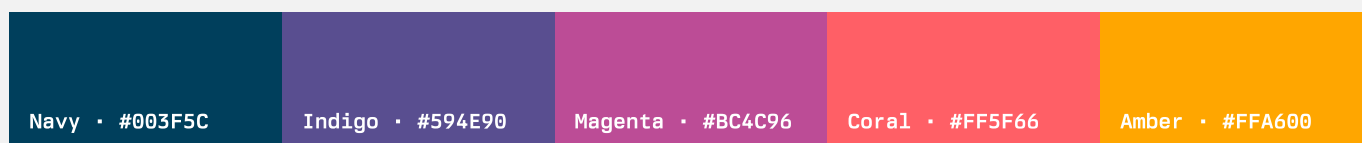
- **One series gets Cerise. The rest are Deep Teal or grayscale.**
If everything is Cerise, nothing is. Reserve red for the number you want the audience to remember.
- **Gridlines and axes are Medium Gray, hairline weight.**
Never darker than the data. Dashed for non-load-bearing reference lines.
- **Legends sit above and right, sentence case, 11pt max.**
Use the same color order as the data; don't re-sort alphabetically.
- **Source line is mandatory.**
Bottom-left, 8.5pt Medium Gray, plain prose: "Source: ARR cube, finance close, 28 Apr 2026."

SECTION 05 · CHARTS ONLY

Color follows category count.

For categorical charts, the number of series decides which palette governs. Past three categories the core two-color pairing stops separating cleanly, so an extended data-viz ramp takes precedence. This page applies to categorical charts only — sequential scales, KPI numbers, and single-series charts keep the core palette.

Extended data-viz palette · --kv-viz-1 ... 5

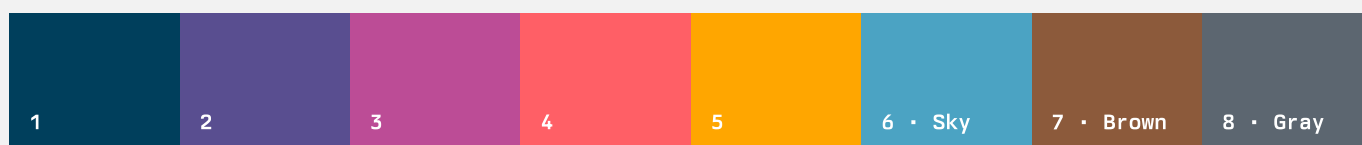


A perceptually-spaced ramp — use the stops in order, no skipping.

The precedence rule

- **1–3 categories — core palette.**
Deep Teal lead, Cerise for the one series that matters, Sky third. Red still means "look here."
- **4–5 categories — the data-viz palette takes precedence.**
Switch entirely to the extended ramp in order. It separates more cleanly than the core palette once you pass three series, and no single hue reads as an alert.
- **6+ categories — extend, then check contrast.**
Append overflow stops drawn from the original palette and verify adjacent slices/bars stay legible.

Overflow stops (6+) & guardrails



- **Readability is the override.**
If two adjacent slices read as one — especially coral/amber on a pie — re-order, add 1px Soft-White separators, or collapse the smallest categories into "Other."
- **Cerise loses its "alert" meaning here.**
In a 4+ category chart, Coral (#FF5F66) is just another series — don't also use core Cerise for emphasis in the same chart.
- **Past eight categories, group the tail.**
Eight distinct hues is the legibility ceiling; anything beyond becomes an "Other" bucket in cool gray.

SECTION 06

Two faces. One weight each.

Hierarchy is built with size, color, and the Cerise marker bar — not with weight changes within a family. The system uses regular weight everywhere.

Display family — FreeSans Display (bold)

Aa Gg
0123

Used for: cover headline, slide title, section divider, KPI numbers, chart titles, key-message blocks. Sentence case. Tracking -0.01em on display sizes.

Text family — FreeSans

Aa Gg 0123

Used for: body, captions, eyebrow trackers, table cells, UI controls, page furniture. Sentence case for prose, ALL-CAPS only for short eyebrows.

Mono — supporting role only

The system pairs both FreeSans faces with a monospace stack **Berkeley Mono** → **JetBrains Mono** → **ui-monospace**. Mono is reserved for:

- **Numerals in tables and chart axes.**
Right-aligned, color set to Deep Teal so they read as data, not body.
- **Reference codes and quarter labels.**
"Q3 · 25", "\$48.2M", "+22% YoY".
- **Token names in this specification.**
--kv-cerise, --fg-2, --s-5.

Fallback stacks

When FreeSans is not available (browser without the font, exported PDF on a different machine), the CSS falls back to **Helvetica Neue** → **Arial** → **sans-serif** for both faces. This keeps layout stable but loses the condensed proportions on display sizes — keep titles short enough that the line breaks don't shift.

SECTION 07

The scale, top to bottom.

Build with clarity.

Display

FreeSans Display

(bold)

96px / 1.05

track -0.01em

A focused statement of strategy

H1 · slide title

FreeSans Display

(bold)

56px / 1.05

track -0.01em

Section heading, sentence case

H2 · section

FreeSans Display

(bold)

40px / 1.2

Sub-heading, regular weight

H3 · sub-head

FreeSans

28px / 1.2

Lead paragraph used to anchor the slide thesis.

Body LG

FreeSans

24px / 1.4

Default running text. Sentence case, plain prose, no decorative flourishes.

Body

FreeSans

20px / 1.4

Footnotes, source lines, and chart annotations sit in Medium Gray.

Caption

FreeSans

16px / 1.4

SECTION · 04

Eyebrow

FreeSans

13px · UC

track +0.14em

SECTION 08

Powers of breathing room.

A tight 4-based scale that doubles cleanly at the upper end. Use the token, not the literal. Decks lean on --s-5 through --s-8 for almost everything.

--s-1		4 px
--s-2		8 px
--s-3		12 px
--s-4		16 px
--s-5		24 px
--s-6		32 px
--s-7		48 px
--s-8		64 px
--s-9		96 px
--s-10		128 px

When to reach for what

- **--s-2 / --s-3 — inside chips, badges, table cell padding.**
Tight, internal spacing.
- **--s-4 / --s-5 — between rows, around small cards, badge gap.**
The default "next to" distance.
- **--s-6 / --s-7 — between sections inside a slide body.**
Between an H2 and the content it heads.
- **--s-8 / --s-9 — page margins, between major slide regions.**
1280×720 slides use 64px outer margin.

SECTION 09

Lines do the work boxes don't.

KV is a line-based system. Cards, borders, and shadows are minimal. Hairlines separate. Cerise rules emphasize. The page accent stripe identifies.

Hairline · 1px

Token: `--hairline`
· `--border`
Color: `#D2D2D2`

**Rule · 2px**

Token: `--rule`
Color: Cerise
(default) or Deep
Teal (table
headers)

**Bar · 4px**

Token: `--bar`
Page accent, key-
message left-
border

**Marker bar**

6 × 42pt Cerise
Always precedes a
slide title

A clear headline

Cover stripe

8px Slate (on
Cerise)
14px on this spec,
8px on slides



Cover slide on Cerise



Shadows & corners

Shadows are essentially absent on slides. `--shadow-1` and `--shadow-2` exist for product UI hover states only. Corners are rectilinear by default (`--radius-0`); 2–4px is acceptable for product UI; pills are reserved for status chips.

SECTION 10

12 columns, 64px outer.

Slides are 1280 × 720 (16:9). The outer margin is 64px on every side. Inside that, content lives on a 12-column logical grid with 24px gutters. Page furniture (top crumb, bottom folio) is consistent on every interior slide.



64px outer

Outer margin on all four sides. Cover and section dividers can use 96px.

12 columns · 24px gutter

Logical grid for content alignment. Most layouts collapse to 2, 3, or 4 visible regions.

Furniture is consistent

Top: section crumb + deck name.
Bottom: hairline + folio + confidentiality.

Slide title anchors

The slide title sits 110px from the top edge, immediately under the header hairline. It always carries the 6 × 42px Cerise marker bar to its left. The body region begins 24px below the title baseline and stretches to 80px above the bottom edge. Cover and section divider slides strip the header, footer, and marker bar.

SECTION 11

Controls that don't shout.

Buttons

PRIMARY

Approve plan

Continue

Cerise fill. White text. The single primary action per surface.

SECONDARY

Review changes

Compare

Deep Teal outline + text on white. Pairs with a primary.

GHOST

Cancel

Skip

Hairline border, Deep Teal text. Tertiary action, dismiss.

DANGER

Reject

Delete

Crimson fill. Reserved for destructive or terminal actions.

INVERSE

Open report

View details

Slate fill, Soft White text. For dark surfaces.

SIZING

Small

Medium

Large

Three sizes. Medium is the default. 2px corner radius across all.

Badges

OUTLINED · STATUS

• SECTION · 02

• ON TRACK

• AT RISK

1px outline matches the text color. Use for state indicators.

FILLED · EMPHASIS

HEADLINE BET

PALE ICE

Filled Cerise for headline tags. Soft Pale Ice for category labels.

SECTION 12

Numbers, in their right place.

KPI tiles

ARR \$48.2 M ▲ 22% YoY	ACTIVE ACCOUNTS 1,284 ▲ 11%
NET RETENTION 118 % ▲ 4 pts	CHURN 2.1 % ▲ 0.3 pts

Top rule is 2px. Cerise marks the tile that contains the number you want the audience to remember; Deep Teal handles supporting numbers. Numerals are FreeSans Display (bold), units small and gray, deltas monospace.

Tables

INITIATIVE	OWNER	FY26 PLAN	Δ VS FY25	RISK
Platform consolidation	Eng	\$4.2M	+18%	Low
Edge runtime launch	Eng · Infra	\$6.8M	+42%	Med
Compliance program	Legal	\$1.1M	-6%	High
Customer migration	CS	\$2.4M	+9%	Low

Header rule is 1.5–2px Deep Teal. Rows separate with 1px hairlines, never a fully-bordered grid. The emphasized row uses Pale Ice fill plus a 3–4px Cerise inset on the leading edge.

SECTION 13

Make the point. Then move on.

Callouts

KEY MESSAGE

Edge runtime is the single biggest lever in the FY26 plan.

INSIGHT

Net retention rose 4 points after pricing simplification
— driven by enterprise expansion, not new logos.

"We picked a direction and stopped negotiating with ourselves."

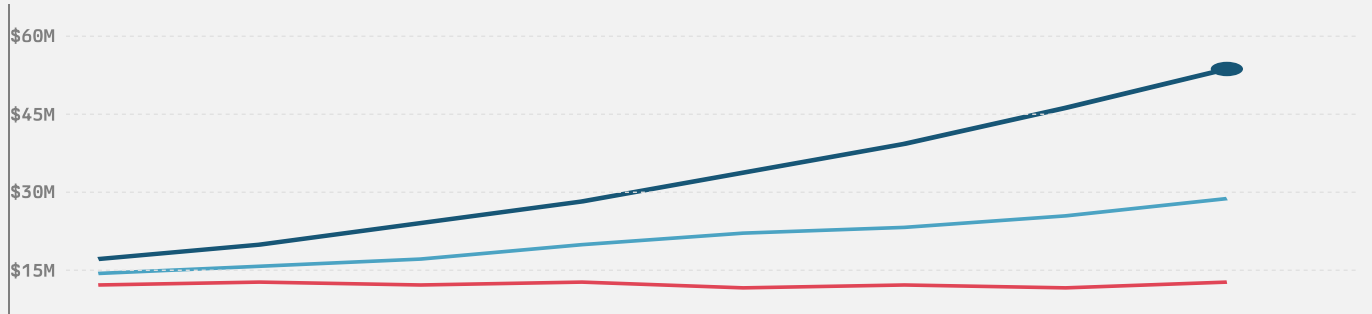
— Engineering retro, March 2026

RISK · HIGH

Compliance certification slips Q3 push launch beyond the trade-show window.

Charts

■ Enterprise ■ Mid-market ■ SMB



Source: ARR cube, finance close, 28 Apr 2026.

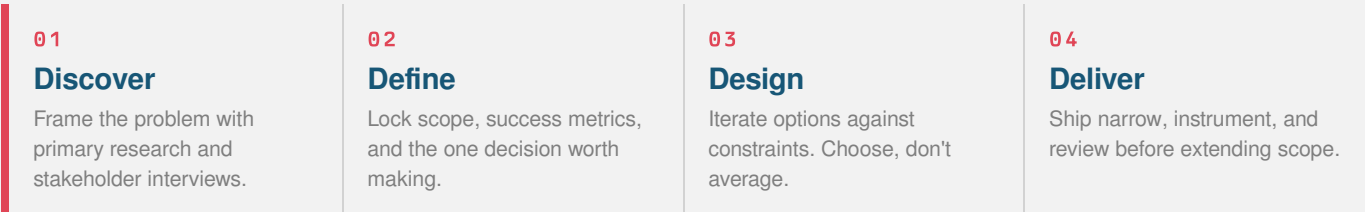
Line weight is 2.5–3px. The lead series is heaviest. Endpoints carry a filled circle so the eye lands. Gridlines dashed, Medium Gray. Y-axis labels mono, right-aligned to the axis.

SECTION 14

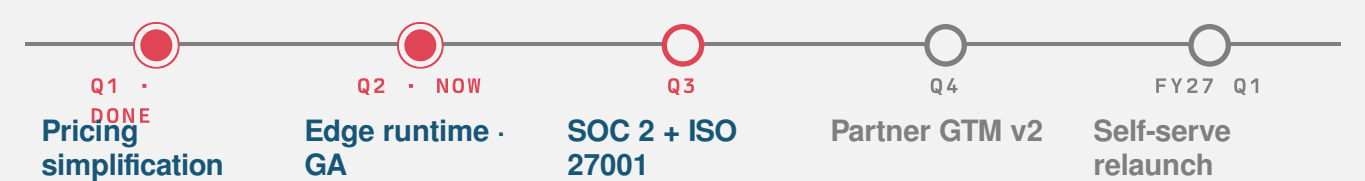
A flow, an arrow, a date.

Step diagrams use vertical hairline dividers and a leading 4px Cerise edge on step 01. Timelines use a single horizontal axis with 18px circular nodes — filled for done, hollow for upcoming.

Process · 4 steps



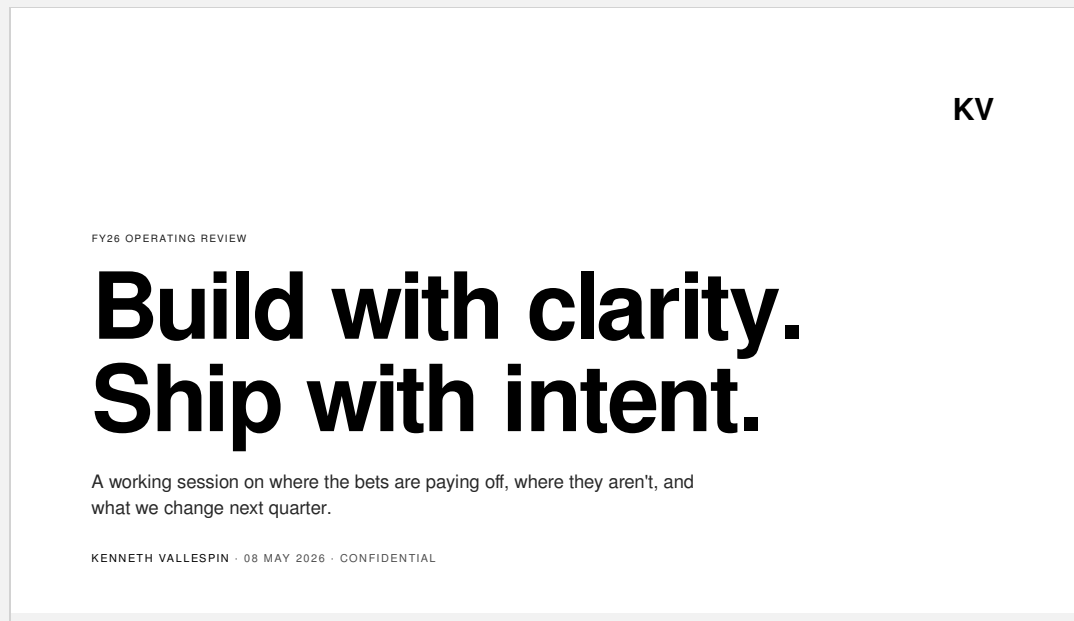
Timeline · quarters



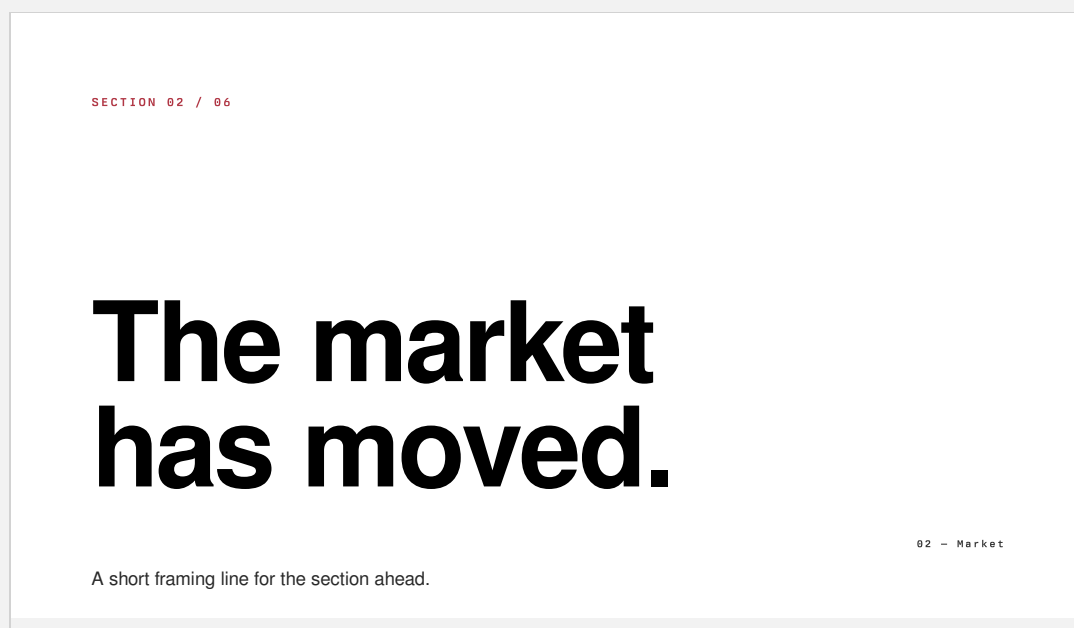
SECTION 15 · MASTERS 01 – 03

Ten layouts. The whole deck.

The system ships ten reusable slide masters at 1280 × 720. Pick the one closest to the message; do not invent new layouts on the fly.



01 Title · cover



02 Section divider

SECTION 15 · MASTERS 03 – 05

Summary, thesis, contrast.

00 · SUMMARY

Executive overview

FY26 review

WHERE WE ARE

Three things to know before we go deeper.

01

Revenue is growing, but mix is shifting.
Enterprise expansion is now the dominant driver. New-logo growth has flattened.

02

The platform bet is working.
Edge runtime adoption beat plan by 38%. It is now the lead in 6 of 10 deals.

03

Compliance is the limiting factor.
Two regulated segments are gated on certifications slipping into Q3.

RECOMMENDATION

Double down on the platform; pull compliance forward at the cost of two minor launches.

KV · Confidential

03 / 24

03 Executive summary

02 · STRATEGY

The thesis

FY26 review

THE SINGLE BET

Own the runtime layer, and the rest follows.

If we're right about where compute moves, every other product decision in this deck is a consequence — not a choice we re-litigate quarter by quarter.

KV · Confidential

04 / 24

04 One message

02 · STRATEGY

What's working / what's not

FY26 review

The platform bet is paying off — distribution still isn't.

Working

SIGNAL

Not working

FRICTION

KV · Design System v1.0

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SECTION 15 · MASTERS 06 – 10

Data, plan, decision, close.

03 · PERFORMANCE

Revenue trajectory

FY26 review

ARR has held its slope; mix has flipped under it.

ARR by segment, last 8 quarters

Enterprise Mid-market SMB

Source: ARR cube, finance close, 28 Apr 2026.

READING

Enterprise is now 64% of new ARR.

SMB is structurally flat. Mid-market is rising slowly. The growth story is enterprise — and the cost-to-serve case follows.

KV · Confidential

06 / 24

06 Chart-heavy

04 · PLAN

Investment by initiative

FY26 review

Where we're putting the money next year.

INITIATIVE	OWNER	FY25 ACTUAL	FY26 PLAN	Δ	RISK
Platform consolidation	Eng	\$3.6M	\$4.2M	+18%	Low
Edge runtime launch	Eng · Infra	\$4.8M	\$6.8M	+42%	Med
Compliance program	Legal	\$1.2M	\$1.1M	-6%	High
Customer migration	CS	\$2.2M	\$2.4M	+9%	Low
Brand & field	Mktg	\$1.8M	\$2.1M	+14%	Low
Total	—	\$13.6M	\$16.6M	+22%	—

■ Highlighted row marks the headline bet for the year.

KV · Confidential

07 / 24

07 Investment table

04 · PLAN

Roadmap

FY26 review

A year, four releases, one big bet.

Q1 · DONE Q2 · NOW Q3 Q4 Q1 · FY27

Platform 1.0 Platform 2.0 Platform 3.0 Platform 4.0 Platform 5.0

KV · Design System v1.0

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SECTION 18

Words are part of the system.

Type and color don't fix bad copy. KV's voice is direct, sentence-case, and slightly understated. The system below is as load-bearing as the palette.

Voice & tone

- **First person plural for team work, singular for opinions.**
"We're putting..." for plans. "I'm recommending..." for decisions. Avoid "you" except in workshops.
- **Sentence case for everything.**
Titles, headings, captions, table cells. ALL-CAPS only for short eyebrows (≤3 words) and section tags.
- **Periods on full sentences in body, omitted on tight headings.**
Em-dashes (—), not hyphens, for asides.
- **Numbers carry their comparison.**
"+22% YoY", "118% (▲ 4 pts)". A number alone is never enough.
- **No emoji. No exclamation marks.**
Unicode arrows (▲ ▼) and dividers (· §) are fine when typographic.

Examples

Do

"The market has moved."
"Pull compliance forward and commit the platform plus-up."
"We picked a direction and stopped negotiating with ourselves."
"ARR is \$48.2M, up 22% YoY."

Don't

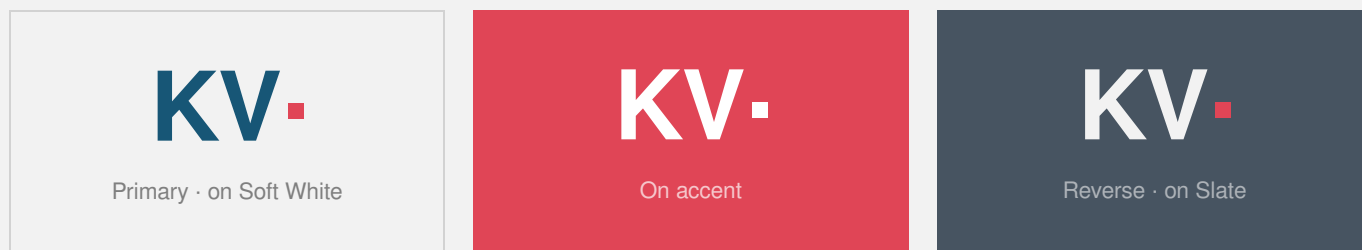
"🚀 Exciting growth ahead!"
"Leveraging our synergies to drive impact."
"Things Are Going Great!!!"
"ARR is doing really well this year."

SECTION 19

Icon-light, mark-precise.

KV is icon-light by default. The wordmark — "KV" in FreeSans Display (bold) with a Cerise dot baseline-aligned to the V — is the only proprietary brand element.

Wordmark



Wordmark is set 56–96px on slides; the dot is sized to ~8% of the cap height and aligned to the V baseline. Minimum size is 24pt — below that, drop the dot.

Iconography

- **Library: Lucide.**
1.5px stroke, no fill, currentColor. Loaded via CDN (<https://unpkg.com/lucide@latest>).
- **Sizes: 16 / 20 / 24 px.**
20 is the deck-default. 16 in tight UI, 24 in nav.
- **Color: --fg-2 (Deep Teal) by default.**
Cerise for active state, Crimson for alert, Sky for info.
- **Never emoji. Never filled icons.**
Unicode glyphs (▲ ▼ — · §) are allowed when typographic.

Imagery

Photography is rare. When used, it is desaturated, high-contrast, and tinted slightly toward Slate / Deep Teal (multiply layer at ~12% opacity). No stock illustrations, no isometric scenes, no AI-generated imagery on production decks.

SECTION 20

Use it. Don't fork it.

The system is small precisely so it stays consistent across every artifact. Below is how to use it day-to-day, and the small set of files that govern it.

Authoring a deck

- **1. Start from a master.**
Copy a slide from the slides/ folder. Don't begin from a blank canvas.
- **2. Use tokens, not hexes.**
Reference --kv-cerise, --fg-2, --font-condensed, --s-5. Hex codes in author files are a smell.
- **3. Keep copy in sentence case.**
Run titles past the "is this a sentence?" test before committing.
- **4. Edit by removal.**
If a slide feels busy, it has too much, not too little.

Files of record

FOUNDATION

colors_and_type.css

Single source of truth for tokens. Every artifact links this — never inline hexes or font stacks.

SLIDES

slides/slides.css + masters

Shared canvas + ten layouts. Treat masters as starting points; do not modify the shared CSS.

AGENT

SKILL.md + CLAUDE.md

Skill entrypoint and project-level instruction file so AI tools default to KV without prompting.

Versioning

This is v1.0 of the KV system, dated 09 May 2026. Major changes (palette, type, layout grid) bump the major version and require a re-export of all decks. Minor changes (new component, additional slide master) bump the minor version and are additive only — they never break existing files.

Open questions / next

- **Mono font is unspecified.**
Falls back through Berkeley Mono → JetBrains Mono → ui-monospace. Pick one and pin it in v1.1.
- **WOFF2 conversion of the FreeSans files.**
Improves web load times; ship in v1.1.
- **Real wordmark.**
The current "KV-" mark is a working placeholder.

IN SUMMARY

One palette. Two faces. Ten layouts. Held tightly.

System owner

Kenneth Vallespin
kenneth@kv.studio

Version & date

v1.0 · 09 May 2026
Next review: 31 July 2026